

url file format

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AI Overview

A .URL file is a **plain-text internet shortcut formatted like an INI configuration file**, used primarily in Windows to store website links. It typically includes an `[InternetShortcut]` header followed by the `URL=` address, which opens in the default web browser when double-clicked.

Basic Structure of a .URL File

These files are created by dragging a web address to the desktop, acting as a desktop bookmark.

- Format:** Plain text.
- Required Section:** `[InternetShortcut]`
- Required Line:** `URL=<target_link>`
- Optional Metadata:** `IconFile`, `IconIndex`, `WorkingDirectory`.

Example File Content

```
ini

[InternetShortcut]
URL=https://www.example.com
```

Key Characteristics

- Function:** Acts as a pointer to a website, similar to a Windows shortcut (.LNK) file, but designed for web resources.
- Compatibility:** Works across most operating systems (Windows, macOS, Linux) and opens in the user's default web browser.
- Editing:** Can be edited or created using any text editor like Notepad.
- Security Risk:** Because they can be used to launch malicious URLs, caution should be taken with unfamiliar .url files.

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May 29, 2023 — The **.URL file format** is not officially documented. Only the URL value in the InternetShortcut section is required, everything else is optional. [Read more](#)

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Overview

Technical Specifications

Working with URL Files



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